



2026 Strategic Sales & Market Development Plan¹

Executive Summary

In 2025, Green Key Global (GKG) built strong momentum across Hotel Brands (HBs), Property Management Groups (PMGs), Thirty-Party Influencers (TPIs), and destination partners. As we enter 2026, our focus is on **scaling adoption**, **deepening partner alignment**, and **removing friction** from the certification process, while strengthening the internal sales engine required to support long-term growth.

The following strategy outlines **five core pillars** that define our 2026 priorities:

- I. Expansion & Partnerships
- II. Simplification & Acceleration
- III. Value & Positioning
- IV. Alignment & Influence
- V. Infrastructure & Enablement

These pillars ensure GKG can meet our member growth target of 1,000 new Green Key Eco (GKE) members with 85% members coming from the US and 15% members from Canada. We expect 850 of the 1,000 new members to come from the US and 150 properties to come from Canada, with the majority sourced from existing brand partners including Best Western Hotels and Marriott International, prioritized net new PMGs, and top destination markets.

I. Expansion & Partnerships

Membership-expansion-through-existing-partnerships)-targeted-outreach)-and-strategic-markets-and-influencer-groups(

IA. Existing Hotel Brand Partnerships

¹ This plan is intended as a living strategy document. It builds on our established work while introducing new growth strategies that will continue to evolve through collaborative input, emerging data and changing market needs.

Two major hotel brand partnerships, Best Western Hotels and Marriott International, will play a critical role in membership expansion, reaching our growth target, and demonstrating industry leadership. They are the most collaborative and engaged.

Best Western (Systemwide GKE Mandate – 500/2,000 hotels adopted)

- Support full portfolio certification by December 2026.
- Continue to execute regional webinar series, bootcamps, and activation campaigns.
- Work with District Managers, council representatives and drive messaging on all platforms and work with influential owners who can advocate for GKE.

Marriott International (Equivalency / Fast-Track Program – 9,700 hotels)

- Launch and operationalize the SPROUT → GKE equivalency workflow.
- Target high-volume adoption following Marriott's 2026 SPROUT cycle.
- Replicate model for additional brand integrations.
- Work with PMGs.

Chain Scale	# of Hotels
Luxury	208
Premium	1,243
Select	4,926
Midscale	6
Timeshare	73

Total Hotels - 6,456

Marriott SPROUT + GKG Fast-Track: Key Dates

- Jan 8: Marriott sends SPROUT announcement to all properties
- Jan 15–31: GKG sends Fast-Track / Equivalency announcement
- Jan 28: SPROUT 2026 officially launches
- Mar 15: SPROUT submission deadline (all properties)
- Feb–Apr: Expected enrollment surge as properties complete SPROUT → Fast-Track into GKG
- Q2: Peak volume and highest conversion period

IB. Net New Hotel Brands and Property Management Company

In 2026, we will target ten PMGs, seven HBs for adoption through structured sales motions, targeted webinars, and co-branded engagements.

HBs

Company	Portfolio Size
Hilton	7,500
Sonesta	1,100
Red Roof	700
Extended Stay America	700
Drury Hotels	150
Omni Hotels & Resorts	50

Total HBs - 19,900 hotels

PMGs

Company	Portfolio Size
Aimbridge Hospitality	1,100
HEI Hotels and Resorts	100+
Summit Hotel Properties	95
NewcrestImage	70+
First Hospitality	70
Davidson Hospitality Group	60
White Lodging	50
Pebblebrook Hotel Trust	45
Vision Hospitality Group	42
Alberigo Hotel Management	14

Total PMGs – 1,644 hotel

Additionally, we will deepen relationships with consulting groups, partners, and vendors that influence sustainability adoption at scale.

2026 Priorities:

- Targeted outreach playbooks and calendars.

- Quarterly leadership touchpoints with HBs, PMGs, and TPIs. Vendor-driven adoption pathways (IncentiFind, WWF, Alo Index, Greenview, Groupe GM, ESG, etc.).

IC. Net New Independent & Boutique Hotels (Portfolio-based strategy)

Independents and boutique hotels represent a large opportunity “low-hanging fruit” but adoption efforts must be portfolio-based, not property by property. Our focus will be on ownership groups, soft brands, and independent/life-style collections, regional associations, and local tourism bodies.

2026 Priorities:

- Identify and target independent hotel groups with 5+ properties.
- Engage state and regional boutique/independent associations.
- Develop tailored collateral emphasizing ROI, credibility, members resources and competitive advantage.
- Integrate independents into destination campaigns (CVB/DMO led adoption).
- Leverage ambassadors and referrals for adoption.

ID. TPIs-Destination Market Strategy – Top 15 U.S. / Top 6 Canada

Destinations influence hotel decisions and can accelerate mass adoption. We will focus on the most traveled and most sustainability-forward markets where hotel density, benchmarking and BPS compliance, and DMO/CVB partnerships converge.

2026 Priorities:

- Expand partnerships with CVBs, DMOs, state associations, and tourism boards.
- Integrate financial incentives, member benefits, marketing upselling, to strengthen the business case.
- Create and launch coordinated “Destination Verified” program with clear conversion goals.
- Develop multi-stakeholder campaigns involving hotels, associations, and local government.
- Understand BPS and how it impacts properties, and local government reporting requirements.

Top 6 Canada Destination Markets

- Toronto, Ontario
- Vancouver, BC
- Montreal, Quebec
- Niagara Falls, ON
- Calgary, AB
- Banff National Park

Top 15 US Destination Markets

Tier 1				
Market	Existing Buildings	12-Mo Demand	12-Mo ADR	12-Mo Occupancy
Las Vegas, NV	308	45,048,169	\$201.21	75.5%
New York, NY	806	37,999,683	\$329.90	84.1%
Orlando, FL	592	37,599,334	\$201.17	71.3%
Los Angeles, CA	1,345	29,940,018	\$195.65	71.6%
Miami, FL	588	17,506,973	\$223.26	73.8%

Tier 2				
Market	Existing Buildings	12-Mo Demand	12-Mo ADR	12-Mo Occupancy
San Diego, CA	536	17,509,640	\$213.14	72.7%
Boston, MA	451	16,255,423	\$232.12	73.2%
Orange County, CA	483	15,911,749	\$207.82	71.9%
San Francisco/San Mateo, CA	467	13,816,735	\$223.37	68.2%
Seattle, WA	395	12,876,901	\$180.09	69.6%

Tier 3				
Market	Existing Buildings	12-Mo Demand	12-Mo ADR	12-Mo Occupancy

Washington, DC	747	27,531,625	\$186.95	66.2%
Denver, CO	463	14,090,589	\$148.98	66.3%
Tampa Bay, FL	613	13,830,791	\$177.78	72.0%
Phoenix, AZ	565	17,368,415	\$172.74	66.3%
Austin, TX	453	11,875,133	\$165.53	64.0%

**12-mo demand = refers to the total number of rooms sold over a 12-month period.*

IE. MSA & MOU Modernization

Consistent and modernized partner agreements will support clearer alignment and smoother collaboration. While this work is most suitably handled within our operations team, we are pleased to offer support as needed. We will revisit the MSA and MOU templates and adapt them for brands, PMGs, CVBs, and DMOs to ensure they reflect our 2026 goals. A more tailored approach will better meet the needs of our partners.

2026 Priorities:

- Update pricing structures, flexibility, and deliverables.
- Tailor terms to each partner type – HBs, PMGs, CVBs & DMOs, State/Regional Associations
- Integration of fast-track pathways into brand agreements (renewals).
- Alignment across legal, MarCom, and partner teams.

II. Simplification & Acceleration

Removing friction and enabling faster pathways to certification across brands/

IIA. Equivalency/Fast-Track Program

The Marriott SPROUT Fast-Track Initiative sets the foundation for how GKG can reduce the self-assessment/certification timeline. The infrastructure built for Marriott serves as the model for future brand integrations.

2026 Priorities:

- Build brand playbooks for teams and property-level adoption.
- Replicate model for Choice (US & Canada), and Wyndham, followed by other HBs.

IIB. Sales Process Optimization (All Programs)

GKE, GKR, and GKM each require clear, differentiated pathways. Simplifying these will increase sales efficiency and conversion rates.

2026 Priorities:

- Standardized outreach → engagement → activation → conversion flow.
 - Program comparison tools, pricing clarity, and upsell pathways.
 - Streamlined onboarding steps for hotels post-purchase, conversions, and new build.
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III. Value & Positioning

Strengthening GKG's commercial value and market credibility

IIIA. Updated Sales Materials & Targeted Messaging

We will modernize all sales collateral to ensure message clarity and alignment with the GKG brand personality: confident, credible, practical, and future-ready.

2026 Priorities:

- Segmented collateral for PMGs, HBs, DMOs, independents hotels, and luxury/lifestyle groups.
- Promotional calendars tied to federal holidays, non-federal holidays, budget season, RFP season, and contract/agreement renewals.
- Visual guides, sales playbooks, and market-specific slide decks.
- Integration of equivalency and fast-track messaging.
- Dedicated messaging for US & Canada market.

IIIB. Promotional Strategy & Seasonal Campaigns

These will be strategically aligned with industry cycles, budget seasons, federal and non-federal holidays, and high-visibility periods.

2026 Priorities:

- Repeat high-performing promotions (e.g., Black Friday, Cyber Monday).
- Introduce new seasonal campaigns (Earth Month, Summer Kickoff, Back-to-Business, New Year).
- Build promotional calendars 90-days in advance with MARCOM.
- Ensure promotions align with pricing flexibility in MSA/MOUs.
- Incorporate targeted codes into trade shows, webinars, and partner campaigns.
- Review and track promotions for conversions and effectiveness.

IIIC. Brand Ambassador Program

To accelerate adoption and strengthen our credibility at the property level, GKG will launch a *Brand Ambassador Program*. This program will identify highly engaged GKE hotels and/or individuals that can serve as peer advocates within their brand, PMG, or regional market. The goal is for Ambassadors to help validate the program and influence adoption (peer-to-peer storytelling).

2026 Priorities:

- Identify 20–30 pilot ambassadors across brands, PMGs, and independents.
- Provide recognition, tools, and training/resources.
- Capture testimonials, case studies, and webinars featuring ambassador properties.
- Leverage ambassadors during events, conferences, and destination campaigns.
- Build a referral pathway so ambassadors can influence adoption within their networks.

IIID. ROI & Business Case Development

More hotels are asking for tangible justification, financial, operational, and commercial, behind certification. We will elevate our value proposition with deeper ROI metrics and proof points.

2026 Priorities:

- Case studies segmented by chain scale and/or by region.
- Conduct research with 10 to 15 member organizations to understand if and how certification has supported a more streamlined RFP process and collect testimonials to inform our value narrative.
- Clear messaging on commercial advantage, compliance readiness, and cost savings.
- Integration of vendor solutions into the ROI/business case narrative.

IV. Alignment & Influence

Strengthening cross-organizational collaboration and industry reach(-

IVA. AHLA & HAC Integration

To ensure broad adoption and internal support, GKG must be strategically embedded across AHLA and HAC teams and initiatives.

2026 Priorities:

- Formal participation in relevant AHLA/HAC committees (Sustainability, GM, Independent & Boutique, THS Regionals, RPM Regionals, AHLA Foundation, FORWARD, etc.) for potential adoption leads.
 - Integration with AHLA Membership, Government Affairs, MarCom, Technology, and Foundation teams to ensure unified messaging, amplify campaigns and partnerships, and share meaningful industry insights that keep us informed of lodging trends and emerging news.
 - Collaboration with HAC and federal/provincial initiatives.
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V. Infrastructure & Enablement

GKG-will-operate-with-a-modern)-predictable)-and-scalable-sales-engine»-supported-by-CRM-tracking-and-automation)-structured-partner-launch-and-activation-plans)-trained-talent)-and-measurable-KPIs(-

VA. Sales Infrastructure, Team Development & CRM

Scaling the sales operation requires modern tools, tracking, automation, and clear responsibilities across the team.

2026 Priorities:

- CRM finalization and data migration (automation, dashboards, forecasting).
- SOPs for sales cycles and partner engagement.
 - Develop standardized processes for HB, PMG, Destination, Brand Sales, etc.
 - Document clear responsibilities, timelines, and touchpoints,
- Training and development for the sales team.
 - Regular coaching on messaging, ROI storytelling, partner engagement, product updates.
- Coverage model evaluation: U.S. brands, PMGs, Canada, and independent segments.
- Quarterly performance reviews and KPI alignment.

VC. Partner Launch Plan

We will create a *Partner Launch Plan* ensuring every partnership moves from contract → activation → sustained adoption (100%).

2026 Priorities:

- Standardized launch plan.

- Create master tracker template with timelines and assign responsibility to respective business lanes.
- Sales team leads the partnership launch, ensuring all internal and external stakeholders are informed of:
 - Partnership details
 - Roles and responsibilities
 - Co-marketing expectations
 - Deliverables and deadlines
 - Activation targets and reporting cadence.

VC. Hospitality Industry Awareness & Owner/Operator Community Engagement

To stay informed and maintain a strong knowledge/presence across the hospitality industry, sales team must actively monitor and participate in relevant hospitality-related spaces. This enables earlier visibility into market trends, owner sentiment, opportunities, and risks.

- Stay informed on all major hospitality-related activities, including brand updates, ownership changes, operational trends, policy changes, and industry events.
- Join and observe owner/operator community groups, including Facebook groups, WhatsApp groups, LinkedIn communities, franchise owner forums, and regional hospitality networks.
- Identify emerging discussions, concerns, or opportunities that may influence adoption or partnership strategies.
- Share relevant insights internally to ensure GKG stays proactive, not reactive, in the market.
- Engage respectfully, focusing on listening, learning, and identifying opportunities rather than hard selling.

VD. Trade Show Engagement Strategy

We will strategically approach trade shows and pre-plan activities ahead of the event to drive visibility and build relationships.

2026 Priorities

- Pre-event preparation: attendee lists, targeted outreach, appointment-setting.
- Structured booth strategy and resource utilization.
- Post-event checklist and follow-up cadence (72-hour rule).

VE. Referral Program

To support organic, scalable growth, GKG will launch a structured *Referral Program* designed to reward existing individuals who introduce new hotels to GKG (GKE, GKR, GKM).

2026 Priorities:

- Build a referral workflow into CRM.
 - Create referral incentives (discounts, credits, recognition, ambassador perks).
 - Promote referrals during onboarding, webinars, and partner activations.
 - Track referral volume and conversion rates.
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Conclusion

The 2026 strategy sets GKG up for strong growth by expanding our reach, strengthening partner relationships, and improving how we operate as a sales team. With clearer pathways, better messaging, and strong alignment with AHLA and HAC, we are well positioned to reach 1,000 new members and continue building GKG as the leading sustainability certification program for the hotel industry.

Appendix

United States

Destination Market	State	Official DMO	CVB/Tourism Org
NYC	NY	NYC Tourism + Conventions	NYC Tourism + Conventions
Las Vegas	NV	LVCVA	LVCVA
Miami	FL	Greater Miami CVB	Greater Miami CVB
Denver	CO	Visit Denver	Visit Denver CVB
Boston	MA	Meet Boston	Meet Boston CVB
Chicago	IL	Choose Chicago	Choose Chicago
Orlando	FL	Visit Orlando	Visit Orlando
Los Angeles	CA	LA Tourism & Convention Board	LA Tourism & Convention Board
San Diego	CA	San Diego Tourism Authority	San Diego Tourism Authority
San Francisco	CA	San Francisco Travel	San Francisco Travel
Seattle	WA	Visit Seattle	Visit Seattle
Washington	DC	Destination DC	Destination DC
Philadelphia	PA	Visit Philadelphia	Visit Philadelphia / PHLCVB
Honolulu (O'ahu)	HI	Hawai'i Visitors & Convention Bureau / O'ahu Visitors Bureau	HVCB / O'ahu Visitors Bureau
Austin	TX	Visit Austin	Visit Austin CVB

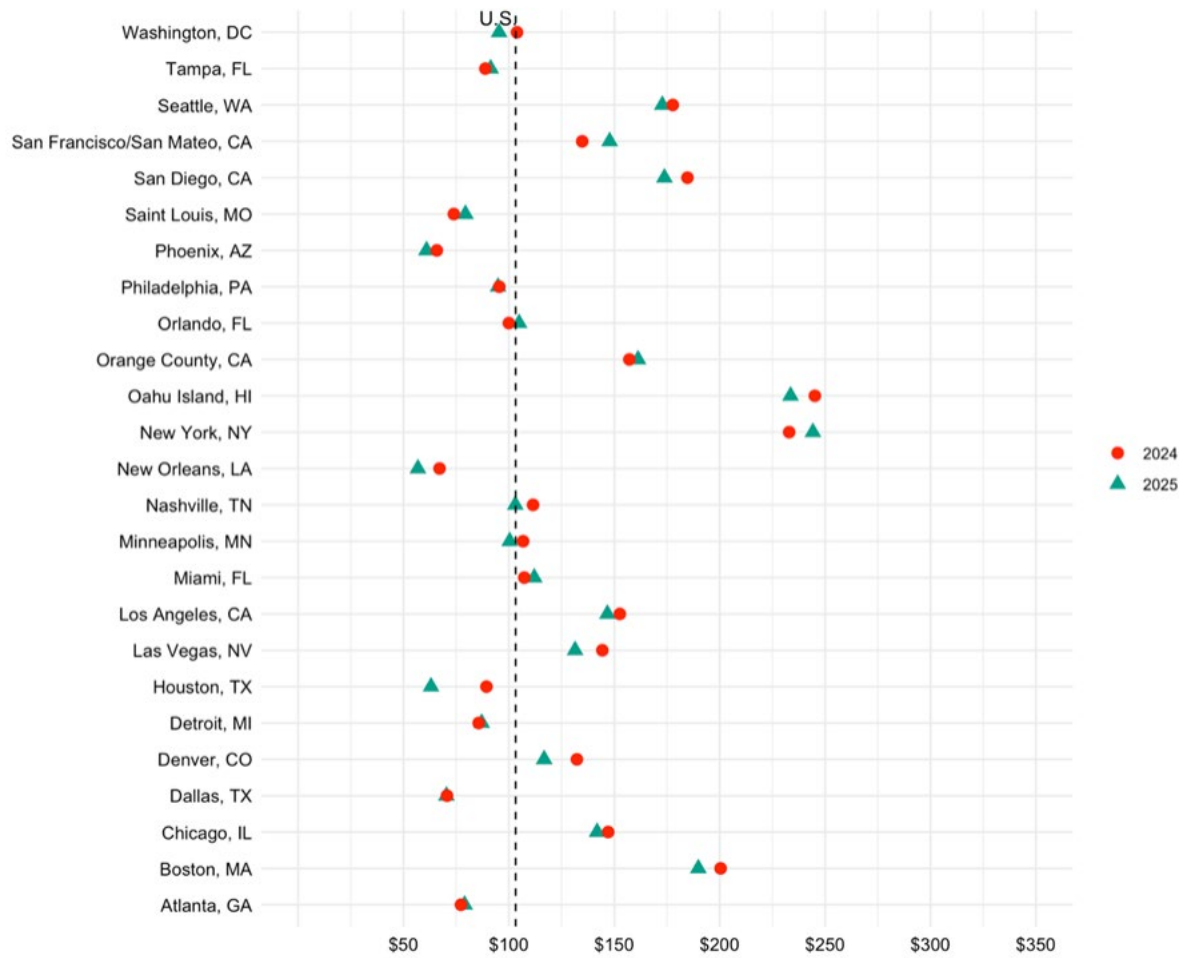
State	Association
California	California Hotel & Lodging Association (CHLA)
Nevada	Nevada Hotel & Lodging Association (NHLA)
Florida	Florida Restaurant & Lodging Association (FRLA)
Hawaii	Hawai'i Lodging & Tourism Association (HLTA)
Colorado	Colorado Hotel & Lodging Association (CHLA-Colorado)
Massachusetts	Massachusetts Lodging Association (MLA)
Illinois	Illinois Hotel & Lodging Association (IHLA)
Texas	Texas Hotel & Lodging Association (THLA)

Washington	Washington Hospitality Association (represents lodging + restaurants)
New York State	New York State Hospitality & Tourism Association (NYSH&TA)
Pennsylvania	Pennsylvania Restaurant & Lodging Association (PRLA)
District of Columbia	Hotel Association of Washington, DC
Arizona	Arizona Lodging & Tourism Association (AzLTA)
Oregon	Oregon Restaurant & Lodging Association (ORLA)
Utah	Utah Tourism Industry Association (lodging + tourism)

City	Lodging / Hotel Association
New York City	Hotel Association of New York City (HANYC)
Las Vegas	Nevada Hotel & Lodging Association (city-state overlap)
Miami	Greater Miami & Beaches Hotel Association (GMBHA)
Denver	Colorado Hotel & Lodging Association (Denver hotels included; no separate city association)
Boston	Greater Boston Hotel Association (GBHA)
Chicago	Illinois Hotel & Lodging Association (covers Chicago; no separate city-level org)
Orlando	Central Florida Hotel & Lodging Association (CFHLA)
Los Angeles	Hotel Association of Los Angeles (HALA)
San Diego	San Diego County Lodging Association (SDCLA)
San Francisco	Hotel Council of San Francisco
Seattle	Seattle Hotel Association
Washington, DC	Hotel Association of Washington, DC
Philadelphia	Greater Philadelphia Hotel Association (GPHA)
Honolulu / O'ahu	Hawai'i Lodging & Tourism Association (HLTA — major presence on O'ahu)
Austin	Austin Hotel & Lodging Association (AHLA—local chapter, not to be confused with the national AHLA)

United States Top 25 Markets, RevPAR(\$)

September 2025 vs. September 2024



Level	Organizations / Groups	Works With
National Marketing	Brand USA	State Tourism Offices, U.S. Travel, CVBs/DMOs
National Advocacy & Industry Organizations	U.S. Travel Association, AHLA, AAHOA, Destinations International (DI)	State lodging associations, CVBs, DMOs, industry partners
State Tourism Agencies	State DMOs (e.g., Visit Florida, Travel Texas, Visit California)	CVBs, city DMOs, state lodging associations
State Lodging / Hotel Associations	CHLA (CA), FRLA (FL), THLA (TX), HLTA (HI), NHLA (NV), etc.	State tourism offices, city hotel associations, CVBs/DMOs
City Hotel Associations	Hotel Association of NYC, GMBHA (Miami), CFHLA (Orlando), Hotel Council SF, Seattle Hotel Association, etc.	Local CVBs/DMOs, state lodging associations
CVBs (City Convention & Visitors Bureaus)	NYC Tourism + Conventions, LVCVA, Visit Denver, Destination DC, Visit Orlando, Choose Chicago, etc.	DMOs, hotel associations, attractions, chambers, event groups
Local/Regional DMOs	Destination Toronto, Visit Austin, Visit Seattle, SF Travel, etc.	CVBs, hotels, attractions, economic development agencies
Local Tourism Businesses	Hotels, attractions, restaurants, museums, sports venues, airports	CVBs, DMOs, Chambers, state tourism



Canada

1. National Tourism Agency –
 - a. Destination Canada (DC)
2. Provincial & Territorial Tourism Agencies

Province

- Travel Alberta (Alberta)
- Destination BC (British Columbia)
- Travel Manitoba (Manitoba)
- Tourism Saskatchewan (Saskatchewan)
- Ontario Tourism / Destination Ontario (Ontario)
- Bonjour Québec (Québec)

- Tourism New Brunswick (New Brunswick)
- Tourism Nova Scotia (Nova Scotia)
- Newfoundland & Labrador Tourism (Newfoundland & Labrador)
- Tourism PEI (Prince Edward Island)

Territories

- Northwest Territories Tourism
- Travel Yukon
- Nunavut Tourism

3. Regional / City-Level DMOs (Destination Marketing Organizations)

Major DMOs

- Tourism Toronto
- Tourism Vancouver (now part of *Destination Vancouver*)
- Tourism Montreal
- Tourism Calgary
- Banff & Lake Louise Tourism
- Tourism Whistler
- Tourism Ottawa
- Explore Edmonton
- Tourism Victoria

Regional DMOs

- Tourism Niagara (Niagara Falls region)
- Travel the Rockies / Canadian Rockies DMOs
- Destination Northern Ontario
- Tourism PEI Regional Councils